

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | SIEM, EDR/XDR, Microsoft Azure Cloud Security, Incident Response
United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience in senior cyber security analyst roles, specialising in proactive day-to-day cybersecurity operations, incident response, threat hunting, and embedding security good practice into change programmes. I have extensive hands-on experience with Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, including Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, and Splunk. I am highly experienced in Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) operations, including CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and I have a strong understanding of network and endpoint security, firewalls, and intrusion detection and prevention systems (IDS/IPS). I bring in-depth expertise across Microsoft Azure cloud security technologies and concepts, including Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender. I am experienced in coordinating threat hunting exercises, procuring and applying threat intelligence, and managing vulnerability management programmes. I take a security by design approach to change initiatives and collaborate closely with stakeholders to ensure that cybersecurity requirements are embedded from the outset. I am well suited to joining a professional services environment where technical depth, operational discipline, and clear communication with the business are essential.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, workspace design, analytics rules, playbooks, workbooks); CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; Splunk/SPL
- **EDR/XDR Solutions:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) -- expert level; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR)
- **Microsoft Azure Cloud Security:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD); Conditional Access; MFA/SSO; Azure cloud security services and concepts
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle; MITRE ATT&CK framework; senior escalation lead; playbook authoring
- **Threat Hunting and Intelligence:** SIEM-driven threat hunting; log and event data analysis; threat intelligence procurement and application
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; AppCheck; Nessus; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Network and Endpoint Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall; IDS/IPS; Tanium endpoint management; Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM); MFA/SSO; Group Policy
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting; SOAR automation; Microsoft Sentinel playbook development
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF); CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials+; JISC cyber security

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Undertake efficient, effective, and proactive day-to-day cybersecurity operations for an 8,000-user institution, minimising the risk of security incidents and enabling the organisation to operate safely
- Maintain the capability to react and respond to incidents in an effective and timely manner; serve as senior escalation lead for complex cyber incidents, managing end-to-end response in accordance with the NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle

- Provide expertise and cybersecurity requirements to the institution's change programme, ensuring that security good practice is embedded into change initiatives and that security by design principles are applied from project outset
- Coordinate and conduct regular threat hunting exercises by analysing logs and event data across SIEM platforms (Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM) using KQL and SPL, and by procuring threat intelligence to inform hunts
- Operate and tune CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR) across the estate; write and maintain detection analytics rules and SOAR playbooks
- Manage Microsoft Azure cloud security technologies including Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA/SSO configuration, and identity governance across the organisation
- Monitor and manage firewalls, IDS/IPS, and network security controls; investigate alerts and anomalies from across network and endpoint layers
- Oversee vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS; coordinate remediation with technical teams and track findings to closure
- Author and maintain incident response playbooks and contribute to continuous improvement of the organisation's cyber security posture

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed proactive day-to-day cybersecurity operations including SIEM alert triage and investigation, EDR/XDR event analysis, IDS/IPS monitoring, and vulnerability tracking
- Deployed and managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR platform, building hybrid SOC capability and supporting ongoing detection engineering and threat hunting activities
- Supported 8,000-user Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment, including policy configuration, onboarding, and sustained alert management
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO, ensuring identity security across the estate
- Conducted regular vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus; reported findings and coordinated remediation with technical and application owners
- Contributed to security by design activities for the institution's change programme, reviewing new systems and services against security standards and providing security requirements at the design stage
- Supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials+ compliance activities; contributed to internal audit and risk assessment processes
- Maintained BeyondTrust privileged access management (PAM) controls and Microsoft Intune mobile device management (MDM) and mobile application management (MAM) policies

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported day-to-day cybersecurity operations in a SaaS/FinTech environment, including SIEM monitoring, alert triage, and incident escalation
- Administered endpoint security tooling, Check Point Harmony firewall, and network security controls; monitored IDS/IPS alerts and investigated anomalies
- Managed Microsoft Azure cloud security services including identity and access management, MFA/SSO, and Group Policy for a distributed workforce
- Conducted vulnerability scanning, patch management, and remediation tracking; supported penetration test finding resolution
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities and supported the change programme by providing security requirements at the design stage

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Established and led end-to-end threat hunting capability at UAL, using SIEM event data, threat intelligence, and MITRE ATT&CK adversary tradecraft to proactively identify and mitigate threats before impact

- Authored enterprise incident response playbooks and served as senior escalation lead for complex security incidents, consistently minimising dwell time and business impact in line with NIST 800-61
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR from the ground up, building a hybrid SOC environment with full endpoint visibility across a large, distributed institution
- Led the 8,000-user Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment, providing comprehensive EDR/XDR coverage across the organisation
- Delivered a vulnerability management programme integrating Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, directly reducing the institution's attack surface and improving mean time to remediate (MTTR) for critical findings

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)